

(AD). A large number of clay tablets inscribed with mysterious symbols were found. Sir Evans believed he had discovered the mythical palace of King Minos and the Minotaur's labyrinth, and christened the inscriptions and languages they represented as 'Minoan'. Evans spent his remaining life trying to decipher the inscriptions with limited success. Three writing systems were used, including somekind of hieroglyphic script, Linear A and Linear B. Out of these three only Linear B has been deciphered, the rest are yet to be understood. It is believed that the hieroglyphic script led to Linear B which led to Linear A, though the relationship is unclear. Linear B was largely deciphered in the 1950s. Although Linear A and Linear B share a lot of symbols, Linear A is still a mystery waiting to be solved.

Phaistos Disc

The Phaistos Disc is a disc of clay obtained from Crete, Greece from about 2000 BC. It is covered on both sides by a spiral of stamped symbols. Its



Phaistos Disc

purpose, meaning and where it was manufactured continues to be a mystery making it one of the most famous archaeological ciphers. The disc was discovered by Italian Luigi Pernier in 1908. It features a number of tokens and unique signs presumably made by pressing of discs into the soft clay. Numerous attempts have been made to crack the cipher. Despite existence of uncertainty on whether there is script behind the signs, most decipherments

assume this. Attempts at deciphering the code seem unlikely to succeed without further examples of signs. It is believed that there is not enough material available for a meaningful analysis. It is also speculated that this disc could be used to decipher Linear A.

Rongorongo Script of Easter Island

Rongorongo is the system of writing discovered on Easter Island. The people of Easter Island were probably inspired to invent the Rongorongo script after seeing the writing used by the Spanish. Rongorongo was used till the 1860s after which the knowledge was lost. With the advent of missionaries, attempts were made to understand the language. Numerous attempts have been made at decipherment; none have been successful